Birth & Early Life

Most Rev Ing Dr Daniel Kojo Gyampa Markin was born in Cape Coast on 25th March 1963 to Robert Kobina Aboadwe Markin, an Assistant Commissioner with the Customs Service, and Comfort Ama Serwaa Mensah, daughter of Prophet John Mensah, the Founder of the Church of Christ (Spiritual Movement), both of blessed memory. At birth, he was christened Kojo Gyampa after his paternal granduncle.

In accordance with the tradition at the time to make for family bonding and social cohesion, Kojo Gyampa and his immediate elder brother, Ben, who was affectionately called Sofo Ben having been named after their granduncle, the Rev B.A. Markin of the Methodist Church, were sent to live with their grandparents in Winneba, Kojo Anyimako Markin and Madam Hagar Yarney.

Being born into the Markin family with its roots in Methodism, Kojo Gyampa was enrolled at the Winneba Methodist Primary School from Kindergarten to Primary 5. He then relocated with his brother to Tera to join the family. He finished off his primary education at Republic Road School and continued to the Twediase Middle School in Community 1, Tema.

Secondary & Tertiary Education

In 1976, Kojo passed the Common Entrance Examination and was first enrolled Asamankese Secondary School in Form 1.

He continued in Suhum Secondary Technical School (Suhum SecTech) in Form 2 on account of his desire to build up himself in the sciences where his proficiencies laid. He became the Dining Hall Prefect. His sense of purpose promptness, attention to detail and the aura of his personality made the school authorities to rethink whether they were rather mistaken in not appointing him as

the School Prefect. He also joined the cadet corps at Suhum SecTech where his inner discipline which he had inculcated rubbed off on other members of the corps.

In 1981, he successfully passed the GCE Ordinary Level Examinations excelling in Mathematics, Additional Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, Biology and Technical Drawing and proceeded to the Sixth Form in the same school where he offered Mathematics, Physics and Chemistry at the Advanced Level (A' Level), completing in 1983. Owing to the backlog of admissions to the university on account of student demonstrations against the PNDC Government which necessitated the closure of the universities for a year, Kojo became one of the first batch of graduating A' Level students to do National Service. With the discipline that he had imbibed from his cadet training at the Suhum SecTech, Kojo did his post-A' Level National Service with the Customs, Excise & Preventive Services (CEPS). This was to offer him an opportunity to enroll for military training at the CEPS Training School at Kpetoe in the Volta Region for him to further imbibe the culture of military discipline.

Academic & Campus Life

In 1985, Kojo proceeded to the University of Science and Technology (UST), Kumasi to do Mechanical Engineering and graduated successfully with a BSc Honors in 1989. While he was at UST, his exuberance and the love for Christian fellowship came to the fore. He immersed himself strongly in the Inter-Hall University Christian Fellowship (IHUCF) where he cultivated useful links with some of the budding Christian leaders of the day.

Not being a person to end his education at the first-degree level and with the desire to soar to the pinnacle of academic excellence and with the knack for figures, Kojo later enrolled at the Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration (GIMPA) to do an Executive MBA in Finance.

He was also conferred with honorary doctorate degrees in Business Administration and Development by the Asland University in Ohio, USA and St Thomas A. Beckett University in Canterbury, Kent, England.

Early Professional Life

Kojo's entrepreneurial spirit and his enthusiasm made him to be appointed the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Comesco Enterprises Ltd, a budding haulage family business which had been established by his mother upon his graduation from UST. His appointment as the CEO received overwhelming support from all the family. The business was set up with a single haulage truck but due to Kojo's enterprising spirit, he grew it to a multiple truck haulage business with forklifts and other equipment. Comesco Enterprises Ltd became very successful and even in its nascent years employed young graduates and young lawyers to put the business on the right footing, a situation which was rare at the time.

Political Activities

With his spiritual background and deep-seated belief arising out of his inner spiritual being that, transformational leadership for the upliftment of society and especially the vulnerable was a duty entrusted to leaders by God to perform, Kojo immersed himself in politics. He saw this as an opportunity to fulfill another aspect of the call of God on his life to transform society. Accordingly, with the lifting of the ban on political activities in July 1992, Kojo in association with another like-minded persons and his elder brother, Phanuel who is domiciled in the US but had come home at the time, formed the Democratic People's Party (DPP). The party eventually aligned with the National Democratic Congress (NDC) to win the 1992 and 1996 presidential and parliamentary elections. He was the General Secretary and later the Chairman. His influence and astute

organisational abilities particularly, a catchy advert on TV in the run up to the 1996 elections was deemed to have largely swayed the minds of the electorate to ensure a second term victory for then President Rawlings.

Service to the State

Kojo's forthrightness, integrity and sincerity of heart made him a natural choice for the conferment of positions of responsibility and trust by the first two presidents of the 4th Republic who won the elections on the ticket of the NDC, the party that he was aligned to.

Having turned down ministerial positions which would have put him in the limelight and at the forefront, he preferred to work behind the scenes to influence policy and give direction for good governance. Consequently, in 1997, he was appointed by the late President J.J. Rawlings as a member of the National Economic Team under the Chairmanship of the then Vice President, late Prof John Evans Atta Mills.

From 1997 to 1999, he served as a member of the Value Added Tax (VAT) Oversight Committee and was instrumental in the drafting of the VAT Bill for consideration by Parliament, drawing on his knowledge of Finance and Taxation.

Concurrently, he served as a member of the Communications Resource Group of the Ministry of Communications, a body which was tasked with formulating policies for an enhanced media environment and also to create the framework for the establishment of the National Media Commission.

Between 1998 and 2000, he was also appointed by the President of the Republic as a member of the Cabinet Legal and Political Sub-Committee which had among other duties, the assessment and vetting of Government appointees to State bodies. At the same time, he was appointed by the Vice President of the Republic, His Excellency the late Professor J.E.A. Mills as a member of the Government's In-House Committee at the Castle which was responsible for monitoring, advising and giving direction to Government ministries and agencies in the implementation of government policies. The Committee was chaired by the Vice President himself. Other positions of trust and responsibility which were conferred on the late Most Rev Ing Dr Markin was a member of the Oversight Committee of the Progressive Alliance made up of the NDC, Egle Party and the DPP. He was also the Chairman of the Board of Directors of the Kwame Nkrumah Memorial Park.

Between 1999 and January 2001, he was the Chairman of the Board of Directors of the Ghana Highway Authourity.

Following the assumption of office of the late Professor J.E.A. Mills as the President of the Republic in January 2009, Most Rev Ing Dr Markin was appointed the Chairman of the Board of

Directors of the Ghana Railway Development Authority which was a new entity set up to see to the accelerated development and modernisation of Ghana's railway system.

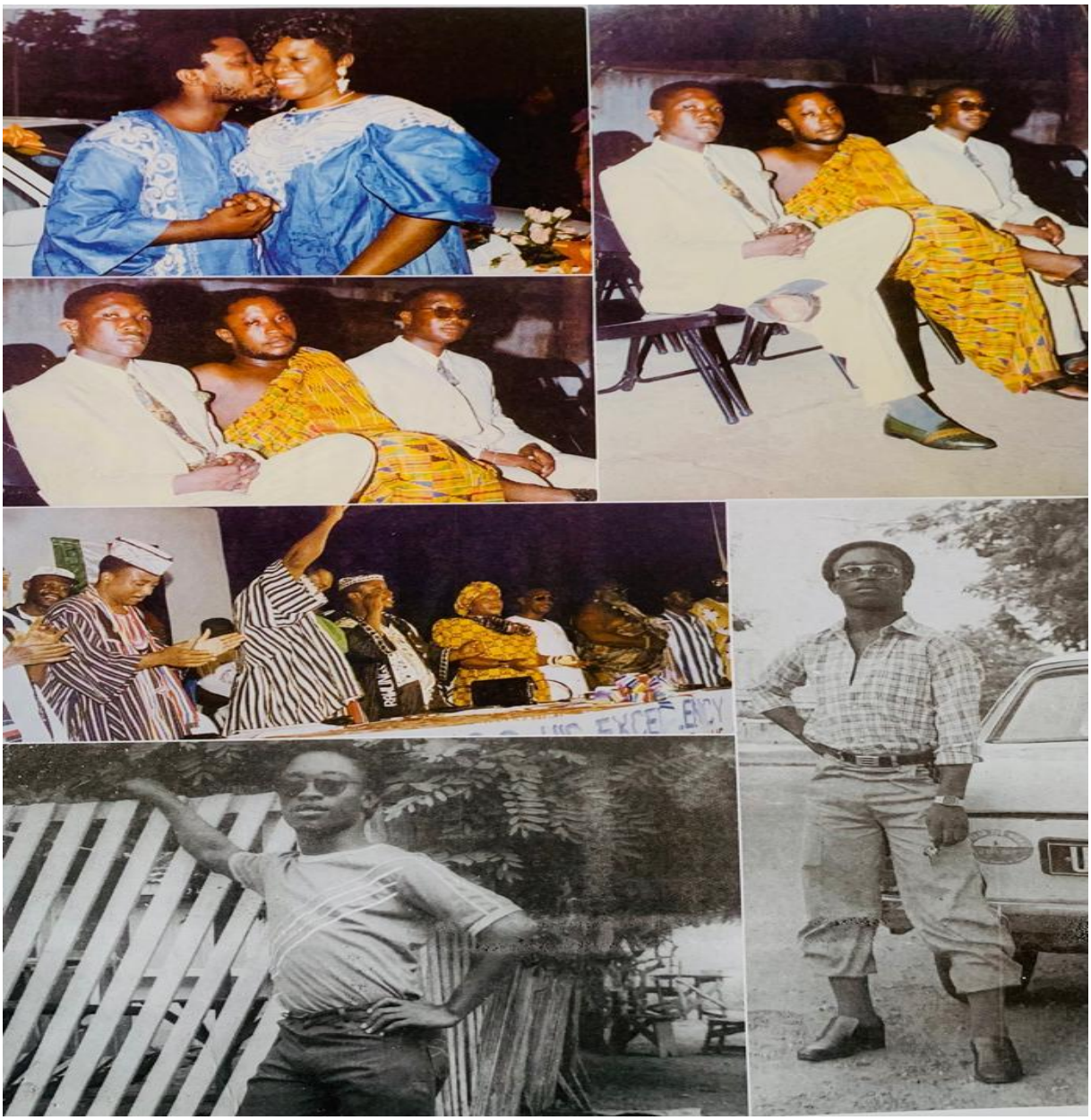
Even though Kojo's service to the State in official capacity was during the tenure of NDC governments, he cultivated useful political links across the political divide.

Entrepreneurial Life

Most Rev Ing Dr Markin was a multi-faceted person and he lived true to the words of Christ to render unto Caesar what belongs to Caesar and to God what belongs to God. He did not see his life as one to be compartmentalised into a single slot but believed that the energies God deposited in him could be applied to uplift men and give hope in the spiritual and physical realm as well. Consequently, Most Rev Ing Dr Markin, although a deeply religious person, also manifested his entrepreneurial spirit as the fulfillment of the call of God on his life to render unto Caesar what belongs to Caesar and to God what belongs to Him.

In giving vent to his entrepreneurial spirit, he set up a number of businesses among them Uniex Ltd, a management and financial consultancy firm which was incorporated in Ghana and the US; Markin Hills Ltd, a construction company which was determined to change the face of housing in Ghana by constructing a number of real estate projects to erase the housing deficit or bring it down substantially; and Miracle Wave Ltd, a christian entertainment and media production company.

In his business and entrepreneurial life, Most Rev Ing Dr Markin mentored a number of young business people, taught them the rudiments and inculcated in them the discipline of prudent business management.



Spiritual Life & Headship of The Church of Christ (Spiritual Movement)

Most Rev Ing Dr Markin's transformation into a spiritual leader and his eventual consecration as the Head of the Church of Christ stemmed from an inner spiritual awakening and transformation under the direction of the Holy Spirit from his Sixth Form days which caused him to immerse himself deeply in spiritual matters. This is not surprising as he was nurtured in a spiritual home.

His paternal ancestry straddled a long line of Ministers in the Markin family of the Methodist Church. His maternal grandfather, Prophet John Mensah, founded the Church of Christ.

He was also caught up by the charismatic wave and fellowshipped with the Lighthouse Chapel International in its formative years where he played the saxophone.

In 2015, his long years of dedication and spiritual consolidation in the Church of Christ was cemented with his coronation as the Head at an impressive ceremony which was attended by many dignitaries.

Most Rev Ing Dr Markin's emphasis as the Head of the Church of Christ and also as a Pastor was salvation, righteous living, being in tune with the Holy Spirit, the resurrection among others. He delivered soul inspiring messages and particularly during this COVID era when the necessity has been created for virtual services, Most Rev Ing Dr Markin chose his themes for delivery at Sunday services as he was led by the Holy Spirit. In his sermons, he sought to demonstrate the purpose of Jesus' life as being the way of love, the truth and life giver.

Family Life

Most Rev Ing Dr Markin got married to Evelyn Warewaa Chemphe, an Educationist, at the Assemblies of God Church in Community 4, Tema in April 1992 and was blessed with 4 children including a set of twins. An interaction with his children shows their good Christian upbringing, all inspired by their father with the support of his wife.

Most Rev Ing Dr Markin was an exuberant and a vivacious person and was in very good health.

Very much against the expectations of family, friends, associates and church members, we received the news of his unfortunate passing when he answered the call of his Maker to be with him in eternity on Friday, 30th July 2021.

May his soul rest in perfect peace.